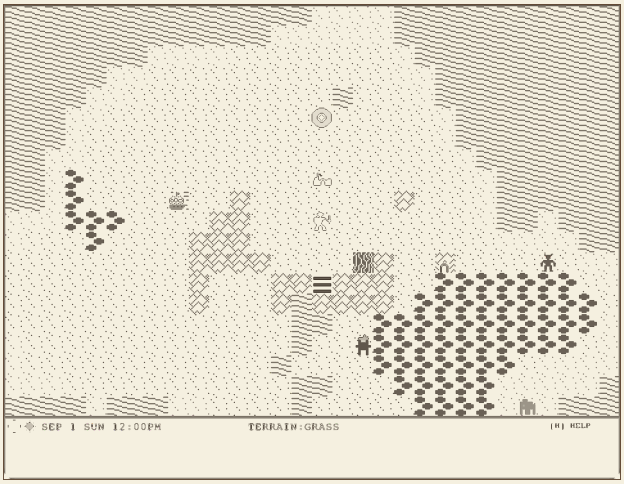
REALM OF SHADOW



THE BOOK OF PLAY

A Player's Guide to the Lands of Shadow

An Ultima III-Inspired Tactical Fantasy RPG

Welcome, brave adventurer! Long have the lands of Shadow awaited a champion bold enough to face the darkness that gathers at the edge of the world. The people whisper of ancient evils stirring in forgotten dungeons, of cursed treasures guarded by creatures born of nightmare, and of a shadow that grows longer with each passing day.

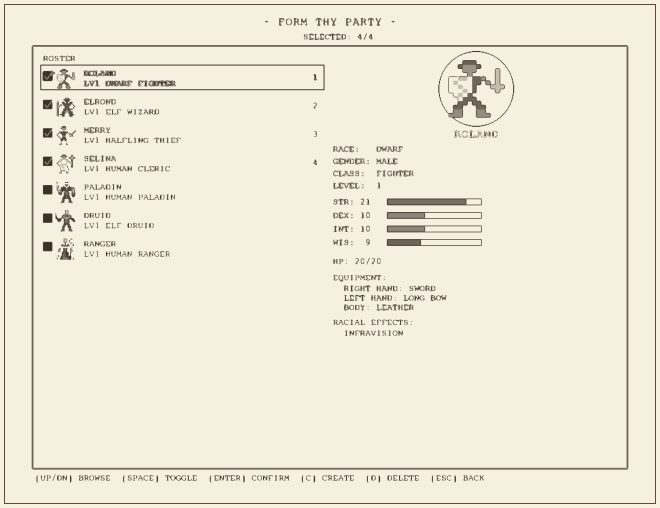
Thou art Called, and from such a Calling none may turn aside. Gather thy companions, arm thyself well, and prepare for the trials ahead. The road will be long and perilous, but glory and honor await those who persevere.

PREPARING FOR THY JOURNEY

Realm of Shadow is a turn-based tactical RPG where thou dost lead a party of up to four adventurers through a dangerous world. Explore the overworld, delve into dungeons, trade in towns, and engage in grid-based tactical combat against a host of enemies.

Thy party shares a pool of gold and a communal inventory, but each character maintains their own equipped gear, hit points, magic points, and experience. Choose thy party wisely — a balanced group with frontline fighters, healers, and spellcasters will fare better than one that leans too heavily upon a single role.

Two paths lie before thee. Thou may choose to venture forth alone, recruiting retainers as thou dost encounter them in the towns and villages of the realm. Or, thou may gather thy companions before setting out, forming a party at the start and equipping each member for the challenges ahead. Either way, heed this counsel: ***the wilderness is unforgiving, and a lone adventurer rarely survives long.***



The party creation screen, where adventurers are shaped by thy hand. Choose each companion's race, class, and attributes with care.

THE RACES OF THE REALM

Five races walk the lands of Shadow, each possessing unique strengths and innate abilities. Thy choice of race will shape thy character's attributes and grant a special power that no training can replicate. Consider well which race best complements the profession thou hast in mind.

Human

Versatile and adaptable, excels in no single area but has no weaknesses.

STR	DEX	INT	WIS
+0	+0	+0	+0

Innate Ability — Fast Learner: Humans require only 750 XP per level instead of the standard 1000, allowing them to level up 25% faster than other races. This compensates for their lack of stat bonuses and makes them an excellent choice for any class.

Dwarf

Stout and hardy, natural miners and warriors with keen underground senses.

STR	DEX	INT	WIS
+2	-1	+0	+1

Innate Ability — Infravision: Dwarves can see in total darkness. Dungeon corridors that would be pitch-black to other races are dimly visible to a Dwarf, eliminating the need for a torch or Light spell.

Halfling

Small and nimble, surprisingly resilient and hard to hit.

STR	DEX	INT	WIS
-2	+2	+0	+1

Innate Ability — Pickpocket: Halflings can attempt to steal items from town NPCs. This ability has a daily cooldown and a chance of failure — use it wisely.

Elf

Graceful and keen-minded, with a natural affinity for magic and sharp senses.

STR	DEX	INT	WIS
-1	+1	+2	+0

Innate Ability — Galadriel's Light: Elves can conjure a soft magical illumination, lighting up dark areas without consuming a torch. This ability has a daily cooldown.

Gnome

Clever and curious, combining tinkering skill with innate magical talent.

STR	DEX	INT	WIS
-1	+0	+2	+1

Innate Ability — Tinker: Gnomes can repair broken equipment and craft simple items from reagents. This ability has a daily cooldown.

THE PROFESSIONS

Eight professions are available to the aspiring adventurer. Each determines thy character's combat prowess, magical abilities, allowed equipment, and special skills. The choice of profession is perhaps the most important decision thou wilt make, for it shapes the entire course of thy adventure.

TABLE 1

Characteristics of each Profession

	HP/Lvl	MP/Lvl	Range	Spell Type	Best Armor
Fighter	15	0	4	None	Plate
Wizard	4	15	2	Sorcerer	Cloth
Cleric	6	10	2	Priest	Chain
Thief	5	0	6	None	Leather
Paladin	10	5	4	Priest	Plate
Ranger	10	3	4	Priest	Chain
Druid	5	12	2	Both	Cloth
Alchemist	4	8	4	Sorcerer	Cloth

Fighter

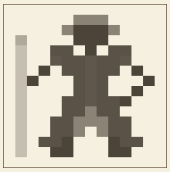
The quintessential warrior — tough, versatile, and deadly in melee.

HP/Level	MP/Level	Range	Spell Type
15	0	4	None

Allowed Weapons: All weapons

Allowed Armor: All armor (Cloth, Leather, Chain, Plate)

Fighters are the backbone of any party. With the highest HP per level, a generous 4-tile combat range, and access to every weapon and armor type, they belong on the front line where the fighting is thickest. They wield no magic but more than compensate with raw staying power and devastating damage output.



Wizard

Master of arcane forces — fragile but devastatingly powerful at range.

HP/Level	MP/Level	Range	Spell Type
4	15	2	Sorcerer

Allowed Weapons: Fists, Dagger

Allowed Armor: Cloth only

Wizards command the most diverse and powerful spell list in the game. From Fireball to Lightning Bolt, Charm Person to Animate Dead, they reshape the battlefield. Their weakness is severe — the lowest HP per level, no armor, and only daggers for weapons. Keep them behind thy front line and let them rain destruction from safety.

Arcane Focus — Spell damage is increased by the Intelligence modifier.

Cleric

Holy warrior and healer — the party's lifeline in long fights.

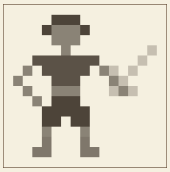
HP/Level	MP/Level	Range	Spell Type
6	10	2	Priest

Allowed Weapons: Fists, Club, Mace, Sling

Allowed Armor: Cloth, Leather, Chain

Clerics are the primary healers of the party. Minor Heal, Major Heal, Mass Heal, and the ultimate Restore spell keep everyone standing, while Cure Poison removes dangerous status effects. They can also fight respectably in melee with maces and clubs, wear chain armor, and devastate undead with Turn Undead. Every party should have one.

Turn Undead (Level 2+) — Channels holy energy that strips 50% of HP from all undead enemies on the battlefield.



Thief

Quick, cunning, and deadly from the shadows — unmatched utility.

HP/Level	MP/Level	Range	Spell Type
5	0	6	None

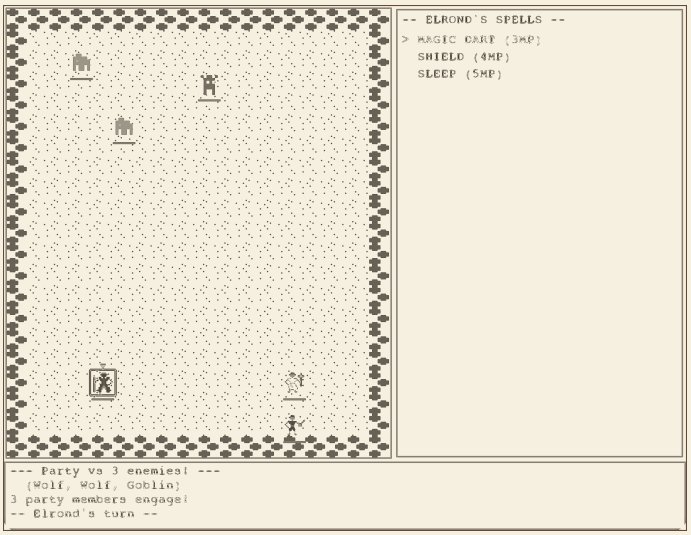
Allowed Weapons: Fists, Dagger, Club, Sling, Short Bow

Allowed Armor: Cloth, Leather

The Thief has the longest combat range of any class (6 tiles), making them effective skirmishers who can outmaneuver most opponents. With a Short Bow they can pelt enemies from a safe distance. At Level 3, Backstab turns the humble Dagger into a devastating weapon. At Level 7, Shadow Step transforms them into true hit-and-run fighters. Their real value outside combat is Pick Locks and Detect Traps, which open up areas and loot that other classes cannot reach.

Pick Locks — Open locked doors and chests. **Backstab** (Level 3+) — Critical hits with daggers on a DEX save. **Shadow Step** (Level 7+) — Move after attacking.

COMBAT



A pitched battle on the tactical grid. Each character and monster acts in initiative order, moving and attacking on the 18 x 21 tile arena.

As thou dost travel in a party, so doth the monsters. When combat is joined, a special combat screen appears. On this new screen, each member of thy adventure party is shown separately, as is each monster. Each character may individually control their actions during combat — moving, fighting, or casting spells.

At the start of combat, every combatant rolls initiative: d20 + DEX modifier. Higher rolls act first. Thy party members take turns in order, then all monsters act, then the cycle repeats. When a character attacks, the game rolls d20 + Attack Bonus against the target's Armor Class. A natural 1 always misses. A natural 20 always hits and doubles the damage dice. Be careful of thy positioning — monsters can attack on diagonals while characters can only strike in cardinal directions.

Movement:

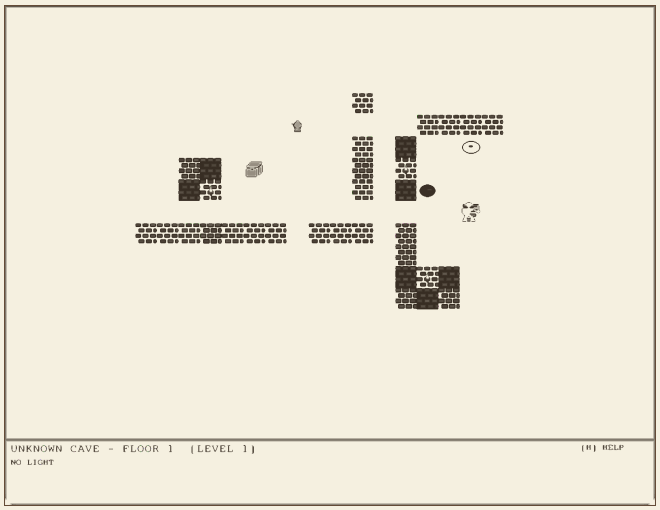
During their turn, a character may move using the WASD keys. Each class has a base movement range. Walk into an adjacent enemy to trigger a melee attack. Use the arrow keys to fire ranged weapons in cardinal directions. Press spacebar to skip thy turn and defend, gaining +2 AC until thy next turn.

Status Effects:

Effect	Duration	Description
Sleep	3-5 turns	Target skips all turns; broken by damage
Poison	4 turns	Takes damage at start of each turn
Curse	3-5 turns	-2 AC and -2 attack penalty
Charm	3 turns	Humanoid monster fights for the party

Invisible	3 turns	Monsters cannot target the character
Blessed	4 turns	+2 attack bonus for all allies
Shielded	3 turns	+1 AC bonus

DUNGEONS

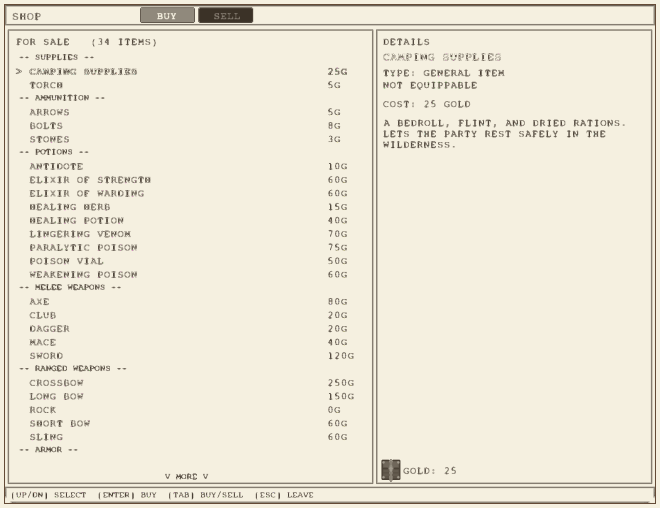


A view of a deep, dark dungeon. Explore carefully — treasure chests, monsters, and hidden passages await.

The dungeons have, of late, become particularly treacherous and deadly. Explore carefully and slowly. Secret doors abound throughout the different dungeons. Magical winds howl down the corridors, blowing out all light. If thou walks slowly, glimpses of faint mystic writings may be noticed periodically.

There also exist many traps and pitfalls for the unwary. A Thief is an excellent choice to have in a party. If the party puts the Thief at the front, thou wilt have an excellent chance of spotting traps before they are sprung. Many strange and wonderful places are hidden within different dungeons, such as fountains. Some fountains are beneficial, while others are poisonous. Always drink carefully at a fountain.

TOWNS & COMMERCE



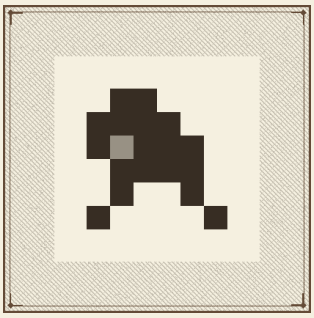
A merchant's shop. Buy and sell weapons, armor, and supplies to prepare thy party for the challenges ahead.

The towns of the realm offer respite from the dangers of the wilderness. Walk into an NPC to speak with them — merchants, healers, and quest-givers all have wisdom to share and goods to trade. Speak to all of them, for some hold valuable clues to the locations of hidden items and secret passages.

Bare is the back who hast not kin to protect it! Decide quickly — equip thy party with the finest weapons and armor thy purse can afford. The party's ability to survive depends as much on the quality of its equipment as on the quality of its leader. Forget not to obtain enough Food, for towns are widely scattered and starvation is always so unpleasant to watch.

A BESTIARY OF SHADOW

The lands of Shadow teem with dangerous creatures, from vermin in the cellars to terrible beasts lurking in the deepest dungeon halls. Herein is a field guide to the monsters thou shalt encounter on thy journey. Study it well, for knowledge of thine enemy is the first step toward victory.



GIANT RAT

A common pest found in basements and dungeon tunnels. Weak alone, but they attack in swarms.

HP: 8 • AC: 12 • Attack: +2 • Damage: 1d4

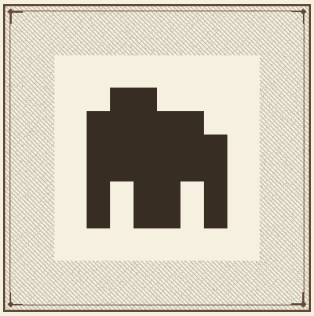
Found in dungeons and house basements. Swarms of rats are a frequent first encounter for new adventurers. They pose little individual threat but can overwhelm the careless.

GOBLIN

Small, sneaky creatures that attack in groups. They carry thrown rocks for ranged harassment.

HP: 6 • AC: 11 • Attack: +2 • Damage: 1d4

Ranged: Thrown rock (range 4, 1d3). Goblins are cowardly but cunning — they prefer to pelt the party from a distance and flee when cornered.

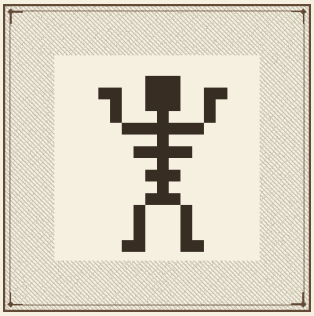


WOLF

Fierce grey wolves that hunt in packs. Fast and cunning.

HP: 12 • AC: 13 • Attack: +4 • Damage: 1d6+1

Found roaming the overworld and in dungeon corridors. Wolves are swift and dangerous in numbers. Keep thy formation tight.

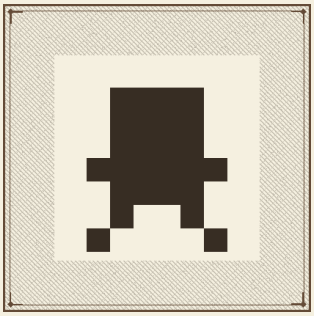


SKELETON

Undead warriors animated by dark magic. Vulnerable to Turn Undead and holy weapons.

HP: 16 • AC: 13 • Attack: +3 • Damage: 1d6+1

Undead — takes massive damage from Turn Undead. A Cleric is invaluable against these foes. Found in dungeons throughout the realm.

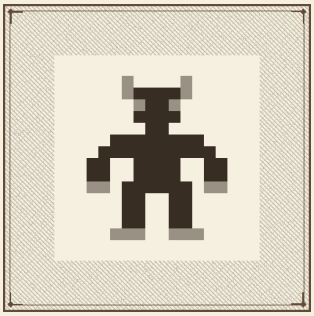


ZOMBIE

Shambling corpses — slow but surprisingly durable. They just keep coming.

HP: 20 • AC: 10 • Attack: +2 • Damage: 1d6+1

Undead — vulnerable to Turn Undead. Zombies are slow but absorb punishment that would fell lesser creatures. Cleave through them quickly.

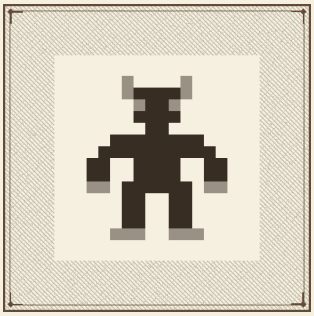


ORC

Brutal and well-armed warriors. A serious threat, especially in groups.

HP: 22 • AC: 13 • Attack: +5 • Damage: 1d8+2

Ranged: Javelin (range 3, 1d6+1). Humanoid — can be charmed. Orcs are among the most dangerous common enemies in the realm.

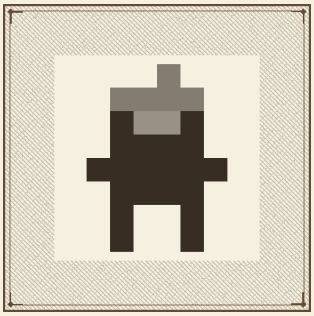


ORC SHAMAN

An orc witch doctor who bolsters allies with healing magic and poisons foes.

HP: 16 • AC: 11 • Attack: +3 • Damage: 1d4

Casts Mend Wounds to heal allies and Poison Spit to weaken the party. Eliminate shamans first to prevent them from healing their warriors.

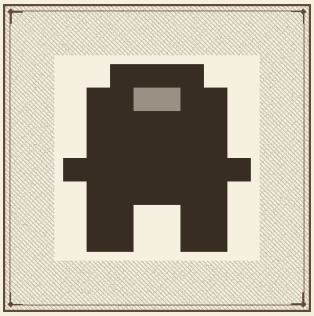


DARK MAGE

A robed figure crackling with dark energy. Attacks from range and casts debilitating spells.

HP: 14 • AC: 12 • Attack: +4 • Damage: 2d4+1

Ranged: Dark bolt (range 7, 2d4+1). Casts Dark Slumber and Hex. Close distance quickly — their ranged attacks are devastating.



TROLL

A massive brute with thick hide. Hits incredibly hard and regenerates health each turn.

HP: 30 • AC: 14 • Attack: +6 • Damage: 2d6+2

Regenerates 1d6+2 HP per turn. Focus fire to overwhelm its regeneration. A Curse spell can reduce its devastating damage output.

Thou art now as prepared as possible to face the trials of thy quest. Drink deep of the fellowship of thy companions, for the morrow may bring thy parting. Journey onward, and may the Gods of the People grant thou victory!